

MINI CAIRN

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<https://github.com/yochaigal/cairn>

Cairn is an adventure game for one facilitator (the **Warden**) and at least one other player inspired by the likes of Chris McDowall's *Into the Odd* and Ben Milton's *Knave*.

Players act as hardened adventurers exploring a dark & mysterious Wood filled with strange folk, hidden treasure, and unspeakable monstrosities.

Character Creation

First, choose a **name** for your character, then choose or roll their **background**, which informs their knowledge and potential skills. Lastly, roll for the rest of your character's **traits** and **gear** on the *Character Traits* and *Starting Gear* tables.

Ability Scores

Player Characters (PCs) have just three attributes:

Strength (STR), **Dexterity (DEX)**, and **Willpower (WIL)**. When creating a PC, the player should roll 3d6 for each of their character's ability scores, in order. They may then swap any two of the results.

Hit Protection

Roll 1d6 to determine your PC's starting **Hit Protection (HP)**, which reflects their ability to avoid damage in combat. HP does not indicate a character's health or fortitude; nor do they lose it for very long (see **Healing**). If an attack takes a PC's HP exactly to 0, the player must roll on the **Scars** table.

Inventory

Characters have a total of 10 inventory slots: a backpack with six slots, one slot for each hand, and two slots for their upper body (such as the belt, chest, or head). The backpack can also double as an emergency

sleeping bag but only if emptied of its contents.

Most items take up one slot, and small items can be bundled together. Slots are abstract and can be rearranged per the Warden's discretion.

Bulky items take up two slots and are typically two-handed or awkward to carry. Anyone carrying a full inventory (e.g. filling all 10 slots) is reduced to 0 HP.

A PC cannot carry more items than their inventory allows. Carts (which must be pulled with both hands), horses, or mules can increase inventory. **Hirelings** can also be paid to carry equipment.

Starting Gear

All PCs begin with:or

- Three days' rations (one slot)
- A torch (one slot)
- 3d6 gold pieces

Roll on the **Starting Gear** tables to determine your PC's armor, weapons, tools, and equipment. If indicated, roll on the *Spellbooks* table with a d100 (or roll 2d10, using one die as the ones place, and one as the tens place).

See the **Equipment List** for related armor, damage, and slot values. Smaller items can sometimes be bundled together into one slot.

Background and Traits (d20 and d10)

Background

1. Alchemist
2. Beggar
3. Butcher
4. Burglar
5. Charlatan
6. Cleric
7. Cook
8. Cultist
9. Gambler
10. Herbalist
11. Magician

12. Mariner
13. Mercenary
14. Merchant
15. Outlaw
16. Performer
17. Pickpocket
18. Smuggler
19. Student
20. Tracker

Virtue

1. Ambitious
2. Cautious
3. Courageous
4. Disciplined
5. Gregarious
6. Honorable
7. Humble
8. Merciful
9. Serene
10. Tolerant

Vice

1. Aggressive
2. Bitter
3. Craven
4. Deceitful
5. Greedy
6. Lazy
7. Nervous
8. Rude
9. Vain
10. Vengeful

Reputation

1. Ambitious
2. Boor
3. Dangerous
4. Entertainer
5. Honest
6. Loafer
7. Oddball
8. Repulsive
9. Respected
10. Wise

Misfortunes

1. Abandoned
2. Addicted
3. Blackmailed
4. Condemned
5. Cursed
6. Defrauded
7. Demoted
8. Discredited
9. Disowned
10. Exiled

Starting Gear (d20)

Armor

- 1-3: None
- 4-14: Studded Leather (Brigandine)
- 5-19: Chainmail
- 20: Plate

Helmets & Shields

- 1-13: None
- 14-16: Helmet
- 17-19: Shield
- 20: Helmet & Shield

Weapons

- 1-5: Dagger, Cudgel, Staff
- 6-14: Sword, Mace, Axe
- 15-19: Longbow, Crossbow, Sling
- 20: Halberd, War Hammer, Battleaxe

Expeditionary Gear

1. Air Bladder
2. Antitoxin
3. Cart (+4 slots, bulky)
4. Chain (10ft)
5. Dowsing Rod
6. Fire Oil
7. Grappling Hook
8. Large Sack
9. Large Trap
10. Lockpicks
11. Manacles
12. Pick
13. Pole (10ft)
14. Pulley

15. Repellent
16. Rope (25ft)
17. Spirit Ward
18. Spyglass
19. Tinderbox
20. Wolfsbane

Tools

1. Bellows
2. Bucket
3. Caltrops
4. Chalk
5. Chisel
6. Cook Pots
7. Crowbar
8. Drill (Manual)
9. FishingRod
10. Glue
11. Grease
12. Hammer
13. Hourglass
14. Metal File
15. Nails
16. Net
17. Saw
18. Sealant
19. Shovel
20. Tongs

TrinketsMagic attacks

1. **Acid Splash:** Hurl a bubble of acid for d8 damage which can be split between 2 adjacent targets.
2. **Fire Bolt:** 1d10 damage. Can light things on fire.
3. **Poison Spray:** d12 poison damage if the nearby target fails a STR save.
4. **Ray of Frost:** Deals d8 cold damage and target has disadvantage on DEX saves.
5. **Shocking Grasp: Deliver a d10 electric shock to a creature you touch.**

1. Bottle
2. Card Deck
3. Dice Set
4. Face Paint
5. Fake Jewels
6. Horn

7. Incense
8. Instrument
9. Lens
10. Marbles
11. Mirror
12. Perfume
13. Quill & Ink
14. Salt Pack
15. Small Bell
16. Soap
17. Sponge
18. Tar Pot
19. Twine
20. Whistle

Bonus Item

Roll on table indicated)

- 1-5: Tool or Trinket
- 6-13: Expeditionary Gear
- 14-17: Armor or Weapon
- 18-20: Spellbook

Spellbooks (d100)

Roll d100 and compare to *100 Spells* section.

Equipment List

(Prices in Gold Pieces)

Armor

- Shield (+1 Armor): 10
- Helmet (+1 Armor): 10
- Padded Armor "Gambeson" (+1 Armor): 15
- Studded Leather "Brigandine" (1 Armor, bulky): 20
- Chainmail (2 Armor, bulky): 40
- Plate (3 Armor, bulky): 60

Weapons

- Dagger, Cudgel, Sickle, Staff, etc. (d6 damage): 5
- Spear, Sword, Mace, Axe, Flail, etc. (d8 damage): 10
- Halberd, War Hammer, Long Sword , etc. (d10 damage, bulky): 20
- Sling (d4 damage): 5
- Bow (d6 damage, bulky): 20

- Crossbow (d8 damage, bulky): 30

Gear & Tools

- Air Bladder: 5
- Bellows: 10
- Bedroll: 5
- Book: 50
- Bucket: 5
- Caltrops: 10
- Cart (+4 slots, bulky): 30
- Chain (10ft): 10
- Chalk: 1
- Chisel: 5
- Cook Pots: 10
- Crowbar: 10
- Drill (Manual): 10
- Face Paint: 10
- Fire Oil: 10
- Fishing Rod: 10
- Glass Marbles: 5
- Glue: 5
- Grease: 10
- Grappling Hook: 25
- Hammer: 5
- Holy Water: 25
- Horn: 10
- Horse (+4 slots): 75
- Hourglass: 50
- Incense: 10
- Ladder (bulky, 10ft): 10
- Lantern & Oil: 10
- Large Trap: 20
- Large Sponge: 5
- Lens: 10
- Lockpicks: 25
- Manacles: 10
- Metal File: 5
- Mirror: 5
- Mule (+6 slots, slow): 30
- Net: 10
- Oilskin Bag: 5
- Pick: 10
- Pulley: 10
- Pole (10ft): 5
- Quill & Ink: 10
- Rations (three day's worth): 10
- Rope (25ft): 5
- Saw: 5

- Sack: 5
- Shovel: 5
- Soap: 1
- Spike: 1
- Spiked Boots: 5
- Spyglass: 40
- Tar: 10
- Tent (fits 2 people, bulky): 20
- Torch: 1
- Wagon (+8 slots, slow): 200
- Wolfsbane: 10

Optional Gear Packages

Cleric

- War Hammer (d10, bulky)
- Chainmail (2 Armor, bulky)
- Gauntlets (+1 Armor)
- Cleansing Blade (d6)
- Holy Symbol (Ward once per day)
- Cloak of the Order

Dowser

- Sickle (d6)
- Patchwork Doublet (+1 Armor)
- Dowsing Rod
- Eyestone (Sense if placed in fresh water)
- Worn Map
- Spyglass

Dwarf

- Prickly Root (d6)
- Pinecone Lattice (1 Armor)
- Trowel
- Jar of Forest Ants
- Poisonous mushroom
- Hand Drill

Elf

- Elegant Sword (d8)
- Recurve Bow (d8)
- Gilt Clothing (1 Armor)
- Spellbook (Charm or Detect Magic)
- Golden Flute
- Air Bladder

Fighter

- Glaive (d10, bulky)
- Scimitar (d8)
- Shortsword (d6)
- Tobacco Pouch & Pipe
- Dice Set

Friar

- Scepter (d6)
- Deceptive Robes (+1 Armor)
- Censer & Holy Water
- Jug of Honey Wine
- Folk Songbook
- Cart (+4 slots, bulky)

Knight

- Longsword (d8, bulky)
- Chainmail (2 Armor, bulky)
- Helmet (+1 Armor)
- Heraldic Cape
- Manacles
- Fine Rope

Magic User

- Fizzled Staff (d8, bulky)
- Dagger (d6)
- Spellbook (random spell)
- Spellbook (random spell)
- Ragged Clothing (hidden pockets)
- Leycap (x2, see Relics)

Thief

- Two daggers (d6+d6)
- Hooded Jerkin (1 Armor)
- Lockpicks
- Caltrops
- Grappling Hook
- Metal File

Ranger

- Longbow (d8, bulky)
- Hatchet (d6)
- Padded Leathers (1 Armor)
- Large Trap
- Bloodhound: 2 HP, 12 DEX, bite (d6)
- Thundering Horn

Rules

Each of the three **abilities** are used in different circumstances (see **saves**, below).

Strength (STR): Used for saves requiring physical power, like lifting gates, bending bars, resisting poison, etc.

Dexterity (DEX): Used for saves requiring poise, speed, and reflexes like dodging, climbing, sneaking, balancing, etc.

Willpower (WIL): Used for saves to persuade, deceive, interrogate, intimidate, charm, provoke, manipulate spells, etc.

Saves

A save is a roll to avoid bad outcomes from risky choices and circumstances. PCs roll a d20 for an appropriate ability score. If they roll equal to or under that ability score, they pass. Otherwise, they fail. A 1 is always a success, and a 20 is always a failure.

Example: *Bea encounters a group of heavily-armed Goblins standing guard before a tunnel entrance. Her player carefully plots a course, recognizing that her 13 DEX makes sneaking past the guards the best option. She rolls a d20, and resulting in a 10 - a success!*

Deprivation & Fatigue

A PC **deprived** of a crucial need (such as food or rest) is unable to recover HP or ability scores. Anyone deprived for more than a day adds **Fatigue** to their inventory, one for each day. Each Fatigue occupies one slot and lasts until they are able to recuperate (such as a full night's rest in a safe spot). PCs can also gain Fatigue by **casting spells** or through events in the fiction.

Healing

Resting for a few moments and having a drink of water restores lost HP but leaves the party exposed. Ability loss can usually be restored with a week's rest facilitated by a healer or other appropriate source of expertise. Some of these services may be free, while more expedient or magical means of recovery may come at a cost.

Armor

Before calculating damage to HP, subtract the target's **Armor** value from the result of damage rolls. Shields and similar armor provides a bonus defense (e.g. +1 Armor), but only while the item is held or worn.

No one can have more than 3 Armor.

Shields, gauntlets, and helms may provide additional benefits according to their use.

Reactions

When the PCs encounter an NPC whose reaction to the party is not obvious, the Warden may roll 2d6 and consult the following table:

- 2: Hostile
- 3-5: Wry
- 6-8: Curious
- 9-11: Kind
- 12: Helpful

Morale

Enemies must pass a WIL save to avoid fleeing when they take their first casualty and again when they lose half their number. Some groups may use their leader's WIL in place of their own. Lone foes must save when they're reduced to 0 HP. Morale does not affect PCs.

Hirelings

PCs can hire **hirelings** to aid them in their expeditions. To create a hireling, roll 3d6 for each ability score, then give them 1d6 HP and a simple weapon (d6), then roll on the *Character Creation* tables to further flesh them out. Hirelings cost between 1-3gp per day, or a share of whatever treasure the party obtains.

Wealth & Treasure

The most common coin is the gold piece (gp), which is equal to 10 silver pieces (sp) and 100 copper pieces (cp).

Treasure is highly valuable, usually bulky, and rarely useful beyond its value. It can be a lure, taking PCs to exotic and even dangerous locations, and is often under the protection of intimidating foes.

Villages, strongholds, and ports of call barter and trade based on the local rarity and value of an item or commodity.

Magic

Spellbooks contain a single spell and take up one slot. They cannot be transcribed or created; instead they are recovered from places like tombs, dungeons, and manors.

Spellbooks sometimes display unusual properties or limitations, such as producing a foul or unearthly smell when opened, possessing an innate intelligence, or being legible only when held in moonlight.

Spellbooks will attract the attention of those who seek the arcane power within, and it is considered dangerous to display them openly.

Scrolls are similar to Spellbooks, however:

- They do not take up an inventory slot.
- They do not cause fatigue.
- They disappear after one use.

Casting Spells

Anyone can cast a spell by holding a Spellbook in both hands and reading its contents aloud. They must then add a Fatigue to inventory, occupying one slot. Given time and safety, PCs can enhance a spell (e.g., affecting multiple targets, increasing its power, etc.) without any additional cost. If the PC is deprived or in danger, the Warden may require a PC to make a WIL save to avoid any ill-effects from casting the spell. Consequences of failure are on par with the intended effect, and may result in added Fatigue, the destruction of the Spellbook, injury, and even death.

Relics

Relics are items imbued with a magical spell or power. They do not cause Fatigue. Relics usually have a limited use, as well as a recharge condition. A few examples:

Honeyclasp, 3 charges. A rusted ring that shrinks the bearer to 6" tall. Recharge: place in a thimble-sized cup of royal jelly.

Falconer's Friend , 1 charge. A bolt-shaped wand carrying the Haste spell. Recharge: fire from a crossbow and recover.

Staff of Silence , 1 charge. This blackened rod temporarily disables all magic within 50ft. Recharge: bathe in the light of a full moon.

Leycap , 1 use. Anyone ingesting this green-flecked mushroom loses a Fatigue, but is then required to make a WIL save to avoid its addictive properties. A fail leaves the PC deprived and unable to focus until they can eat another leycap, providing only a brief reprieve from the addiction.

Combat

Rounds

The game typically plays without strict time accounting. In a fight or circumstance where timing is helpful, use rounds to keep track of when something occurs. A **round** is roughly ten seconds of in-game time and is comprised of turns.

Actions

On their turn, a character may move up to 40ft and take up to one action. This may be casting a spell, attacking, making a second move, or some other reasonable action.

Each round, the PCs declare what they are doing before dice are rolled. If a character attempts something risky, the Warden calls for a save for appropriate players or NPCs. All actions, attacks, and movements take place simultaneously.

Turns

The Warden will telegraph the most likely actions taken by NPCs or monsters. At the start of combat, each PC must make a DEX save to act before their opponents.

Example: *Bea has accidentally stumbled onto the stomping grounds of a massive Wood Troll. In order to make a move before the Troll, she makes a DEX save. She fails, and the Troll gets to attack first.*

Attacking & Damage

The attacker rolls their weapon die and subtracts the target's armor, then deals the remaining total to their opponent's HP. Unarmed attacks always do 1d4 damage.

Example: *The Wood Troll roars, swinging its club at Bea, who has 5 HP. The club does 1d10 damage and the Warden rolls a 4. They subtract 1 to account for Bea's leather armor, leaving Bea with 2 HP remaining.*

Attack Modifiers

If fighting from a position of weakness (such as through cover or with bound hands), the attack is **impaired** and the attacker must roll 1d4 damage regardless of the attack's damage die.

If fighting from a position of advantage (such as against a helpless foe or through a daring maneuver), the attack is **enhanced** , allowing the attacker to roll 1d12 damage instead of their normal die.

Multiple Attackers

If multiple attackers target the same foe, roll all damage dice and keep the single highest result.

Optionally, the Warden may allow subsequent attacks on a target in a round, but they are impaired.

Dual Weapons

If attacking with two weapons at the same time, roll both damage dice and keep the single highest result.

Blast

Attacks with the **blast** quality affect all targets in the noted area, rolling separately for each affected character. Blast refers to anything from explosions to huge cleaving onslaughts to the impact of a meteorite. If unsure how many targets can be affected, roll the related damage die for a result.

Scars

When damage to a PC reduces their HP to exactly 0, they are sometimes changed irrevocably. See the **Scars** for more.

Critical Damage

Damage that reduces a target's HP below zero decreases a target's STR by the amount remaining. They must then make a STR save to avoid **critical damage**. Additionally, some enemies will have special abilities or effects that are triggered when their target fails a critical damage save.

Any PC that suffers critical damage cannot do anything but crawl weakly, grasping for life. If given aid and rest, they will stabilize. If left untreated, they die within the hour.

Ability Score Loss

If a PC's STR is reduced to 0, they die. If their DEX is reduced to 0, they are paralyzed. If their WIL is reduced to 0, they are delirious.

Complete DEX and WIL loss renders the character unable to act until they are restored through extended rest or by extraordinary means.

Unconsciousness & Death

When a character dies, the player is free to create a new character or take control of a hireling. They immediately join the party in order to reduce downtime.

Detachments

Large groups of similar combatants fighting together are treated as a single **detachment**. When a detachment takes critical damage, it is routed or significantly weakened. When it reaches 0 STR, it is destroyed.

Attacks against detachments by individuals are impaired (excluding blast damage).

Attacks against individuals by detachments are enhanced and deal blast damage.

Retreat

Running away from a dire situation always requires a successful DEX save, as well as a safe destination to run to.

Scars

When an attack reduces a PC's HP to exactly 0, they are uniquely impacted. Look

up the result on the table below based on the total damage taken:

1. **Lasting Scar:** Roll 1d6 (1: Neck, 2: Hands, 3: Eye, 4: Chest, 5: Legs, 6: Ear). Roll 1d6. If the total is higher than your max HP, take the new result.
2. **Rattling Blow:** You're disoriented and shaken. Describe how you refocus. Roll 1d6. If the total is higher than your max HP, take the new result.
3. **Walloped:** You're sent flying and land flat on your face, winded. You are deprived until you rest for a few hours. Then, roll 1d6. Add that amount to your max HP.
4. **Broken Limb:** Roll 1d6 (1-2: Leg, 3-4: Arm, 5: Rib, 6: Skull). Once mended, roll 2d6. If the total is higher than your max HP, take the new result.
5. **Diseased:** You're afflicted with a gross, uncomfortable infection. When you get over it, roll 2d6. If the total is higher than your max HP, take the new result.
6. **Reorienting Head Wound:** Roll 1d6 (1-2: STR, 3-4: DEX, 5-6: WIL). Roll 3d6. If the total is higher than your current ability score, take the new result.
7. **Hamstrung:** You can barely move until you get serious help and rest. After recovery, roll 3d6. If the total is higher than your max DEX, take the new result.
8. **Deafened:** You cannot hear anything until you find extraordinary aid. Regardless, make a WIL save. If you pass, increase your max WIL by 1d4.
9. **Re-brained:** Some hidden part of your psyche is knocked loose. Roll 3d6. If the total is higher than your max WIL, take the new result.
10. **Sundered:** An appendage is torn off, crippled or useless. The Warden will tell you which. Then, make a WIL save. If you pass, increase your max WIL by 1d6.
11. **Mortal Wound:** You are deprived and out of action. You die in one hour unless healed. Upon recovery, roll 2d6. Take the new result as your max HP.
12. **Doomed:** Death seemed ever so close, but somehow you survived. If your next save against critical damage is a fail,

you die horribly. If you pass, roll 3d6. If the total is higher than your max HP, take the new result.

100 SPELLS

1. **Adhere:** An object is covered in extremely sticky slime.
2. **Anchor:** A strong wire sprouts from your arms, affixing itself to two points within 50ft on each side.
3. **Animate Object:** An object obeys your commands as best it can.
4. **Anthropomorphize:** An animal either gains human intelligence or human appearance for one day.
5. **Arcane Eye:** You can see through a magical floating eyeball that flies around at your command.
6. **Astral Prison:** An object is frozen in time and space within an invulnerable crystal shell.
7. **Attract:** Two objects are strongly magnetically attracted to each other if they come within 10 feet.
8. **Auditory Illusion:** You create illusory sounds that seem to come from a direction of your choice.
9. **Babble:** A creature must loudly and clearly repeat everything you think. It is otherwise mute.
10. **Bait Flower:** A plant sprouts from the ground that emanates the smell of decaying flesh.
11. **Beast Form:** You and your possessions transform into a mundane animal.
12. **Befuddle:** A creature of your choice is unable to form new short-term memories for the duration of the spell.
13. **Body Swap:** You switch bodies with a creature you touch. If one body dies, the other dies as well.
14. **Charm:** A creature you can see treats you as a friend.
15. **Command:** A target obeys a single three-word command that does not cause it harm.
16. **Comprehend:** You become fluent in all languages for a short while.
17. **Cone of Foam:** Dense foam sprays from your hand, coating the target.
18. **Control Plants:** Nearby plants and trees obey you and gain the ability to move at a slow pace.
19. **Control Weather:** You may alter the type of weather at will, but you do not otherwise control it.
20. **Cure Wounds:** Restore 1d4 STR per day to a creature you can touch.
21. **Deafen:** All nearby creatures are deafened.
22. **Detect Magic:** You can see or hear nearby magical auras.
23. **Disassemble:** Any of your body parts may be detached and reattached at will, without causing pain or damage. You can still control them.
24. **Disguise:** You may alter the appearance of one character at will as long as they remain humanoid. Attempts to duplicate other characters will seem uncanny.
25. **Displace:** An object appears to be up to 15ft from its actual position.
26. **Earthquake:** The ground begins shaking violently. Structures may be damaged or collapse.
27. **Elasticity:** Your body can stretch up to 10ft.
28. **Elemental Wall:** A straight wall of ice or fire 50ft long and 10ft high rises from the ground.
29. **Filch:** A visible item teleports to your hands.
30. **Fish Lung:** A target can breathe underwater until they surface again. Smells strongly of the sea.
31. **Flare:** A bright ball of energy fires a trail of light into the sky, revealing your location to friend or foe.
32. **Fog Cloud:** A dense fog spreads out from you.
33. **Frenzy:** A nearby creature erupts in a frenzy of violence.
34. **Gate:** A portal to a random plane opens.
35. **Gravity Shift:** You can change the direction of gravity, but only for yourself.
36. **Greed:** A creature develops the overwhelming urge to possess a visible item of your choice.
37. **Haste:** Your movement speed is tripled.

38. **Hatred:** A creature develops a deep hatred of another creature or group and wishes to destroy them.
39. **Hear Whispers:** You can hear faint sounds clearly.
40. **Hover:** An object hovers, frictionless, 2ft above the ground. It can hold up to one humanoid.
41. **Hypnotize:** A creature enters a trance and will truthfully answer one yes or no question you ask it.
42. **Icy Touch:** A thick ice layer spreads across a touched surface, up to 10ft in radius.
43. **Identify Owner:** Letters appear over the object you touch, spelling out the name of the object's owners, if there are any.
44. **Illuminate:** A floating light moves as you command. When held in light, the pages become a prism of vibrant rainbows.
45. **Invisible Tether:** Two objects within 10ft of each other cannot be moved more than 10ft apart.
46. **Knock:** A nearby mundane or magical lock unlocks loudly.
47. **Leap:** You jump up to 10ft high, once.
48. **Liquid Air:** The air around you becomes swimmable.
49. **Magic Dampener:** All nearby magical effects have their effectiveness halved.
50. **Manse:** A sturdy, furnished cottage appears for hours. You can permit and forbid entry to it at will.
51. **Madness of Marbles:** Your pockets are full of marbles and will refill every 30 seconds.
52. **Masquerade:** A character's appearance and voice becomes identical to those of a character you touch.
53. **Miniaturize:** A creature you touch is shrunk down to the size of a mouse.
54. **Mirror Image:** An illusory duplicate of yourself appears and is under your control.
55. **Mirrorwalk:** A mirror becomes a gateway to another mirror that you looked into today.
56. **Multiarm:** You temporarily gain an extra arm.
57. **Night Sphere:** A 50ft-wide sphere of darkness displaying the night sky appears before you.
58. **Objectify:** You become any inanimate object between the size of a grand piano and an apple.
59. **Ooze Form:** You become a living jelly.
60. **Pacify:** A creature near you has an aversion to violence.
61. **Passage:** Creates a temporary path through wood, stone or brick.
62. **Phobia:** A nearby creature becomes terrified of an object of your choice.
63. **Pit:** A pit 10ft wide and 10ft deep opens in the ground.
64. **Primal Surge:** A creature rapidly evolves into a future version of its species.
65. **Push/Pull:** An object of any size is pulled directly towards you or pushed directly away from you with the strength of one man.
66. **Raise Dead:** A skeleton rises from the ground to serve you. They are incredibly stupid and can only obey simple orders.
67. **Raise Spirit:** The spirit of a nearby corpse manifests and will answer 1 question.
68. **Read Mind:** You can hear the surface thoughts of nearby creatures.
69. **Repel:** Two objects are strongly magnetically repelled from each other within 10 feet.
70. **Scry:** You can see through the eyes of a creature you touched earlier today.
71. **Sculpt Elements:** Inanimate material behaves like clay in your hands.
72. **Sense:** Choose one kind of object (key, gold, arrow, jug, etc). You can sense the nearest example.
73. **Shield:** A creature you touch is protected from mundane attacks for one minute.
74. **Shroud:** A creature you touch is invisible until they move.
75. **Shuffle:** Two creatures you can see instantly switch places.
76. **Skillful Repair:** You make minor repairs to a nonliving object.
77. **Sleep:** A creature you can see falls into a light sleep.

78. **Slick:** Every surface in a 30ft radius becomes extremely slippery.
79. **Smoke Form:** Every surface in a 30ft radius becomes extremely slippery.
80. **Sniff:** You can smell even the faintest traces of scents.
81. **Snuff:** The source of any mundane light you can see is instantly snuffed out.
82. **Sort:** Inanimate items sort themselves according to categories you set.
83. **Spellsaw:** A whirling blade flies from your chest, clearing any plant material in its way. It is otherwise harmless.
84. **Spider Climb:** You can climb surfaces like a spider.
85. **Swarm:** You become a swarm of crows, rats, or piranhas. You can only be harmed by blast attacks.
86. **Target Lure:** An object you touch becomes the target of any nearby spell.
87. **Telekinesis:** You may mentally 1 move item under 60lbs. .
88. **Telepathy:** Two creatures can hear each other's thoughts, no matter how far apart.
89. **Teleport:** An object or person you can see is transported from one place to another in a 50ft radius.
90. **Thicket:** A thicket of trees and dense brush up to 50ft wide suddenly sprouts up.
91. **Time Control:** Time in a 50ft bubble slows down or increases by 10% for 30 seconds.
92. **True Sight:** You see through all nearby illusions.
93. **Upwell:** A spring of seawater appears.
94. **Vision:** You completely control what a creature sees.
95. **Visual Illusion:** A silent, immobile, room-sized illusion of your choice appears.
96. **Ward:** A silver circle 50ft across appears on the ground. Choose one species that cannot cross it.
97. **Web:** Your wrists shoot thick webbing.
98. **Widget:** A primitive version of a drawn tool or item appears before you and disappears after a short time.
99. **Wizard Mark:** Your finger can shoot a stream of ulfire-colored paint. This paint is only visible to you and can be

seen at any distance, even through solid objects.

100. **X-Ray Vision:** You can see through walls, dirt, clothing, etc.

BESTIARY

Bandit: 4 HP, 11 STR, 14 DEX, 12 WIL, dagger (d6). Thieves who value wealth over all else. Use disguises, stealth, and trickery to surprise victims.

Basilisk: 10 HP, 1 Armor, 12 STR, 13 DEX, 13 WIL, bite (d10). Long, serpentine lizards that nest deep below the earth or in brambles just underfoot. Gaze: A PC meeting the Basilisk's gaze must make a WIL save or turn instantly to stone. Its reflection is harmless. Fighting a Basilisk without meeting its gaze is difficult (direct attacks are Impaired).

Bear: 6 HP, 15 STR, 13 DEX, 5 WIL, claws (d8+d8), bite (d10). Aggressive, 9' tall reddish-brown bears found in mountains, woodlands, and prairies. They prefer to eat fish and meat, and are not opposed to attacking the rare unfortunate to cross their path.

Creeping Vines 8 HP, 10 STR, 12 DEX, 2 WIL, vines (d4, blast). Appear as an inert, typical vine. Attacks passing creatures to use their corpses as fertilizer. Critical Damage: Target is pulled into the air where they asphyxiate within a few minutes.

Demonic Knight: 12 HP, 3 Armor, 16 STR, 8 DEX, 12 WIL, longsword (d10). Once holy warriors who fell to the temptation of dark powers that they now serve in undeath. Rides nightmarish steeds into battle.. Lesser undead creatures mindlessly follow their command. Their evil aura frightens anyone who comes into melee range. Critical Damage: Everyone who sees the knight landing the blow is driven into bloodthirsty hatred.

Dragon, Red: 18 HP, 3 Armor, 18 STR, 12 DEX, 16 WIL, bite (d12), detachment. Flaming titans of smoke and fire, boasting a greater wingspan than any of their brethren. Lair close to volcanos and lava flows. Immune to fire damage of any kind.

Ice and water evaporate on contact. Fire Breath: Deals 8 STR damage to anyone nearby, destroying all mundane armor it touches in the process.

Dryad: 4 HP, 14 WIL, unarmed (d4). Shy, peaceful tree spirits whose manifest in a beautiful female form. Spiritually bound with a tree, may disappear by joining with the tree again. Can't go too far away from it and dies if the tree is destroyed. Charm strangers that come near. Charmed creatures mindlessly walk into the tree, disappearing forever if not rescued quickly.

Elemental, Earth: 12 HP, 3 Armor, 16 STR, 6 DEX, fists (d12). Huge humanoid beings made of earth and stone. Create constant earth tremors with their presence. Can meld into the earth and move through it as if swimming.

Elemental, Fire: 16 HP, 12 DEX, 14 WIL, flare (d10, Blast). Living columns of pure flame that burn everything in their path. Highly vulnerable to being touched by water or rain. Can scatter their flames, freely changing its form.

Elf, Frost: 14 HP, 1 Armor, 8 STR, 13 DEX, 14 WIL, icicle dagger (d6), a Spellbook (Choose one: Sleep, Teleport, Detect Magic). Beautiful, amoral, and long-lived. Resistant to most forms of magic.

Gargoyle: 8 HP, 3 Armor, 14 STR, 6 DEX, 12 WIL, claws (d8+d6). Magical creatures that look like monstrous, horned, winged statues.. Guard places by standing still to pass like inanimate statues and attacking what comes near. Cannot be charmed and put to sleep.

Gelatinous Cube: 8 HP, 15 STR, 6 DEX, 3 WIL, devouring touch (d8). Large cubes of transparent jelly, dwell in dungeons absorbing items and living creatures. Difficult to be detected due to being transparent.. Critical Damage: The target is engulfed into the cube and keeps being absorbed.

Ghost: 8 HP, 15 WIL, cold touch (d4). Incorporeal spirits of the restless dead. Avoids direct confrontation, instead it quietly possesses a target and acts through them when possible. Immune to most forms

of damage, only susceptible to magic and holy water. Possession: One target must save WIL or be possessed, being controlled by the ghost until it's somehow driven off.

Ghoul: 6 HP, 14 STR, 3 WIL, elongated claws jagged teeth (d8+d6). Grey-skinned man-things wearing shredded clothes, hunkering over the ground. Craves the flesh of the living, as it grows only more powerful with each victim. Critical Damage: target is paralyzed. The wound turns fatal in a day if not treated by a priest or skilled healer. If not burned, the body will rise as a Ghoul.

Giant, Frost: 14 HP, 2 Armor, 18 STR, 12 WIL, greataxe (d12+d10) or longbow (d12). 18' tall humanoids with blue-ish skin and pale hair. Wear furs and iron Armor. Unharmed by cold and ice. Excellent trackers, hunt accompanied by dire wolves.

Goblin: 4 HP, 8 STR, 12 DEX, 8 WIL, dagger (d6) or sling (d4). Small, grotesque humanoids with skin in earthly tones of green, brown, and grey. Avoid combat, only attacking when in advantage, using hit-and-run tactics. Sometimes are found using dire wolves as mounts.

Hawk, Giant: 10 HP, 8 STR, 15 DEX, 8 WIL, talons and beak (d8+d6). Large birds of prey, the size of a wolf. Can carry animals up to their size. Hunt animals that they can carry, but might attack humans or greater prey if despaired. Surprise their victims by diving to attack from a great height. Can supposedly be trained to be hunting companions.

Hooded Men: 12 HP, 9 STR, 12 DEX, 14 WIL, leystaff (d8), a Spellbook (Choose one: Charm, Hypnotize, Push/Pull, Shield). The Watchers of the Wood; a cult that derive their power from leylines, rune stones, and the like. Critical damage: leech a part of the victim's soul (1d4 WIL damage).

Mimic: 9 HP, 2 Armor, 13 STR, 12 WIL, bite (d12). Monstrous shape-shifters that take on the form of inanimate objects made of wood and stone. Found only underground. Remain motionless (generally in the form of chests or doors), devouring anything that touches it. The mimic's saliva is extremely sticky, taking great strength to

remove something from its mouth once glued.

Minotaur: 12 HP, 1 Armor, 16 STR, 8 WIL, axe (d10) or horns (d6+d6). A large, muscular humanoid with the head of a bull. Generally lair in a maze or dungeon, making the whole place it's territory.. Notably strong, is able to easily break stone, which it uses to alter the environment and separate its foes to kill then one by one. If the minotaur succeeds in a Critical Damage save, it is driven into a bloodthirsty state, enhancing all its attacks and impairing all attacks against it. Only stops when killed or if it no longer sees any foe.

Octopus, Giant: 8 HP, 14 STR, 8 WIL, tentacles (d6, Blast). Large, eight-armed saltwater creatures. Dwell nearby warm coasts. Can attack up to 8 nearby creatures. When threatened, spills a thick cloud of ink and quickly swims away.

Ogre: 6 HP, 1 Armor, 16 STR, 8 DEX, 6 WIL, club (d10). 10' tall brute humanoids dressed in animal hides. Mostly live in caves. Mostly antisocial, drive away any other beings from nearby its lair. Easily impressed by shiny materials, carry sacks full of coins with them.

Skeleton: 5 HP, 1 Armor, 13 DEX, rusty sword (d6). If a skeleton is killed and its bones are not scattered, it reforms.

Troll, Wood: 12 HP, 15 STR, 12 DEX, 7 WIL, claws and bite (d8+d8 blast). As an action, can recover lost HP. Critical damage: moss and twigs begin growing out of target's wounds.

Wolf: 6 HP, 12 STR, 14 DEX, bite (d8). Large canines that dwell primarily in wildlands, but occasionally lair in caves. Can be trained like dogs if captured young. When found in packs of at least 4, wolfs never fail morale saves.

Wolf, Dire: 8 HP, 14 STR, 12 DEX, bite (d10). Horse-sized, semi-intelligent wolves. Highly territorial, live in forests or mountains and ferociously guard its surroundings. Regular wolves are scared of them, but will fight alongside them against invaders. Can be trained like dogs if

captured young, but it's a extremely difficult challenging.

Wyvern: 7 HP, 14 DEX, bite (d8+d8) or poisonous sting (d6). Winged, two-legged, reptilian monsters with a long tail tipped with a venomous sting. Dwell in any terrain, but favor dry cliffs. Shy away from other creatures, but attacks anything that comes in the vicinity of its nest.. Critical Damage: The deadly poison permanently debilitates the target, reducing its maximum STR to the current value.

Zombie: 6 HP, 6 DEX, 3 WIL, rusted weapon (d6). Slow, mindless re-animated corpses. Created by wicked wizards to serve as guardians in hordes. Simply attacks anything that comes nearby. Cannot be affected by anything that targets the mind.

Creating Monsters

Use the following template to model any more sophisticated Monster or NPC:

Name:

X HP, X Armor, X STR, X DEX, X WIL, Weapon (dX, special items, qualities)

- Engaging descriptor of appearance or demeanor
- Quirk, tactic, or peculiarity making this NPC unique
- Special effect or critical damage consequence

General Principles

Ability Scores: 3 is deficient, 6 is weak, 10 is average, 14 is noteworthy, and 18 is legendary. Adjust as necessary.

- Give average creatures 3 HP, give hardy ones 6 HP, and serious threats get 10+ HP.
- Use flavor and style to help them stand out. Players will remember a pig-faced humanoid looking for his missing sheep more easily than a generic goblin archer.
- Use critical damage to lean into the threat or strangeness of any aggressive NPC.
- Remember that HP is **Hit Protection** , not Hit Points. It's a measure of

resilience, luck, and gumption - not health.

Converting from OSR Games

- Give 1 HP per HD for most creatures.
- Most humanoids have at least 4HP.
- **Morale** can also be used as a baseline.

Some pointers:

- Is it good at avoiding a hit? Give it HP.
- Does it soak up damage? Give it Armor.
- Is it strong? Give it a high **STR**.
- Is it nimble? Give it high **DEX**.
- Is it charismatic? Give it high WIL.

Damage die are roughly the same, though armed attacks do at least 1d6 damage.

OPTIONAL RULES

ADVANTAGE & DISADVANTAGE

A Warden has the option of modifying the difficulty of saves using **Advantage** (where a character rolls two d20 and uses the higher roll) or **Disadvantage** (where a character rolls two d20 and uses the lower roll).

MAGIC ATTACKS

1. **Acid Splash:** Hurl a bubble of acid for d8 damage which can be split between 2 adjacent targets.
2. **Fire Bolt:** 1d10 damage. Can light things on fire.
3. **Poison Spray:** d12 poison damage if the nearby target fails a STR save.
4. **Ray of Frost:** Deals d8 cold damage and target has disadvantage on DEX saves.
5. **Shocking Grasp:** Deliver a d10 electric shock to a creature you touch.

ANCESTRIES

Dwellers of the Underground

- **Darkvision:** Perfect vision in low-light, somewhat blinded by bright lights.
- **Earthhardy:** You are tougher than sun-dwellers, often recovering from injuries or poison thought to be lethal.

Fair Folk

- **Magic-Sense:** You can tell when arcane energies are at work.
- **Third Eye:** You cannot be fooled by magical illusions, save those created by one of your own.

Smallfolk

- **Easily Missed:** Enemies tend to ignore you, going for the bigger targets first or ignoring you altogether.
- **Quicksilver:** Escaping sudden capture or a killing blow is like second nature to you. Sneaking comes naturally, too.

Greenskin

- **Blood Brothers:** If any fellow adventurers go first in battle, then you also go first.
- **Battle Fury:** Once per encounter you may perform an Enhanced blast attack.

Humankind

- **Eclectic:** Humans are many and varied. Select an additional background.
- **Aggressive Opportunist:** Once per encounter, you can re-roll a damage roll.

CLASSIC CLASSES

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Fighter

You are the Mercenary, the Barbarian, the Gladiator, The Knight. You are the master of the arts of combat and warfare

- **Mercenary:** You have a contact you can turn to in almost every city. They aren't always happy to see you, though. Men blindly follow you in battle (they always pass morale saves).
- **Barbarian:** Your place is in the wilderness, you despise civilization and fear magic. You drink blood like ale, regain 1d3 HP when you kill or CD an enemy. Your battle rage is so strong that you can harm creatures immune to mundane damage.
- **Gladiator:** Your favorite weapon is an extension of you (your attacks are enhanced). You are a trained merciless killer. Your reputation is not always serving you and your former master is probably looking for you.
- **Knight:** Your rank gives you credibility with the nobles. The peasantry will generally follow you into dangerous situations without the slightest hesitation. However if you fail them somehow, they may strip you of your rank. You are also a skilled horseman, your mounted attacks are enhanced.

Character creation

- Start with 1d4+2 HP.
- Swirl: do a Blast attack and gain 1 Fatigue.
- Death Storm: when you kill or CD an enemy you can attack again.

Starting Gear

- Roll 1d10+10 on the Armor Table.
- Roll 1d10+10 on the Helmets and Shields Table.
- Roll for Weapons and choose a second one.
- Roll the rest as usual.

Cleric

You are the Priest, the Druid, the Paladin. You are a faithful servant of your deity. Battle ready to channel the power of your cult.

- **Priest:** You always find help and resources in the temple of your deity but stay in line with the dogma of your religion or be disfavored. You can invoke the divine power, brandishing your holy symbol, to repel undead (creatures Save WIL to resist).
- **Druid:** You belong to the wild lands and feel uncomfortable in cities. You worship the elements and the old bestial deities. You can communicate with animals and always find resources in the wilderness. You can shape-shift into your totem animal (get 1 Fatigue when you shift back).
- **Paladin:** As a sacred warrior of your faith you will be obeyed by zealots. Priests will favor you but if you step out of the line you will fall in disgrace. You dedicate your life to the cult and sworn vow of humility (you should not hoard treasures). Once per day you can Lay on Hands on someone to cure disease, poison or heal 1d6 STR.

Character creation

- Salvation Grace: heal 1D6 to any abilities but you became Deprived.
- Miracles: you can choose 3 spells related to your religion to cast without Spellbooks while holding your holy symbol.

Starting Gear

- You start with a holy symbol from your deity.
- Roll 1d12+8 on the Armor Table.
- Roll 1d12+8 on the Helmets and Shields Table.
- Roll the rest as usual.

d20 Cleric Spells

1. **Blessing:** Target's attacks are enhanced and non-Blast attacks are impaired against them until they next take damage.
2. **Cure-All:** A single illness or disease dissipates at your touch.
3. **Curse Unlife:** Deals 1d4+2 STR loss to one undead, ignoring armor and resistances.
4. **Fortify:** Damage from heat, ice, acid or electricity are impaired against a target for the next hour.
5. **Healing Grace:** A target heals 1d6 STR, and you become deprived until you take the time to mediate, pray or sleep.
6. **Induce Despair:** Target must pass a WIL save or its attacks are impaired.
7. **Lichsense:** You feel any undead within 60ft. WIL save to avoid detection by intelligent undead.
8. **Light Show:** You control a dazzling display of light and color.
9. **Linguist:** For the next hour you can speak and understand any mundane language.
10. **Magic Seal:** Magically locks a door, portal or chest.
11. **Master Undead:** Undead creatures obey your command. Intelligent undead make a WIL save.
12. **Otherworldly Gate:** Opens a portal to another reality. It works in both directions.
13. **Passage:** Creates a temporary path through wood, stone or brick.
14. **Perfect Preservation:** A weapon you touch becomes immune to wear, mundane damage or elemental effects. The spell wears off after a day.
15. **Planar Anchor:** Binds an extraplanar creature to your will until it performs a task specific task, after which they must pass a WIL save to escape (good luck).
16. **Ravenless Message:** You send a short message 1 mile that anyone along its path can hear.
17. **Scrying Ward:** For 24 hours you become aware of any magical eavesdropping.
18. **Song of Repose:** Target falls into a deep slumber.

19. **Uncurse:** A person or object you touch is freed from a curse or nefarious spell.
20. **Word of Pain:** A single phrase from your lips does 1d12 blast damage. Affected targets are also deafened.

Magic-User

You are the Wizard, the Necromancer, the Elementalist, the Enchanter. You are the scholar of the arcane, you handle spells and magic like no one else.

- **Wizard:** You have spent time in magic school and libraries, Your knowledge is broad and you often know something about old and forgotten things. You have a small magic creature as Familiar. You can communicate with it telepathically as long as you can see it. If it dies it can be re-summoned during an 8 hours ritual, you end up Deprived.
- **Necromancer:** You manipulate the forces of life and death and have a sick attraction for undead creatures. You will be despised, banished or imprisoned in most settlements. You can speak with recently deceased corpses, they will talk to you like a friend. Get 1 Fatigue at the end of the conversation.
- **Elementalist:** You summon the forces of the four elements: Water, Earth, Fire and Air. You choose one element: You always have 3 Armor against it and your attack spells based on it are enhanced.
- **Enchanter:** You have sharpened your magic ability to seduce and

charm mundane creatures with your words. You can hypnotize an intelligent creature by holding a trinket and speaking directly to him/her. The creature is dazed and confused until a WIL Save is passed.

Character creation

- **Grimoire (Bulky).** This is the fruit of your research and your most precious belongings (only you can decipher it). You can spend four hours to copy a standard Spellbook into your Grimoire followed by a successful WIL Save. During this process the original Spellbook is destroyed. Scrolls cannot be copied.
- You are not comfortable wearing bulky armor. Spell casting wearing one will cost 2 Fatigue.

Starting Gear

- You start with your Grimoire with a random spell inscribed.
- Roll 1d6 on the Armor Table.
- Don't roll on the Helmets and Shields Table.
- Roll the rest as usual.

Thief

You are the Rogue, the Assassin, the Ranger, the Tomb Robber. You are the master of stealth, acrobatics and deception.

- **Rogue:** The larcenous arts are your way of living, you have contacts with the mob in most cities, You always hear the best rumors and nice job proposals. You get cheap equipment from selected shops. Nevertheless, Your reputation will not help you with the authorities and you probably “wanted” somewhere. You know how to cut a purse and you have learned the mysteries of lock-picking. As accomplished burglars you can attempt to climb unthinkable sheer surfaces.
- **Assassin:** You have learned many ways of killing, you are a deadly shadow. You still owe your mentors, probably a guild, and beware of the day they will hold you accountable. With the right ingredients you can brew all kinds of poison. With some observations and study you can create disguises that will fool detailed scrutiny.
- **Ranger:** You are a protector of nature, you are a wilderness survival expert and you know how to travel fast and unnoticed. Always aware, you are rarely surprised. You have a semi intelligent faithful pet of your choice. You have a deep connection with him/her and you will always protect each other. Your pet will always find you back but if it dies you will need to raise a cub.

- **Tomb Robber:** You are stealing things from the dead, they don’t need it after all. You are a specialist of underground exploration and ancient structures. You feel at home in dark and damp places. You have developed skills for disabling traps, only the most advanced one should catch you. You can smell Undead creatures when they are close.

Character creation

- **Backstab:** when you attack an unaware opponent from behind you do STR damage.
- **Read languages:** you can read approximately any text.

Starting Gear

- You start with an Expeditionary Gear and a Tool of your choice.
- Choose a Weapon.
- Roll the rest as usual.